

Market Intelligence Research Brief

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Topic/Company: Global Video Game Market — Platform, Genre & Regional Investment Strategy

1. Research Objective

To determine whether historical video game sales patterns (by platform, genre, and region) still hold in today's market, in order to inform which platform and genre our studio should prioritize for its next major title investment, and which region should be treated as the primary launch market.

2. Scope of Research

- **Markets or industries covered:** Global video game industry, covering mobile, console, and PC platforms; primary regional focus on North America, Europe, Japan, and Asia-Pacific broadly.
- **Competitor types included:** Major platform holders and publishers (Nintendo, Sony, Microsoft/Xbox, Tencent, NetEase, Electronic Arts, Activision Blizzard) — publisher-level competitive concentration, not individual title-level competitive analysis.
- **Timeframe considered:** Internal dataset covers approximately 1980–2016 (retail/packaged unit sales); external research covers 2024–2026 current-state data with forward projections to 2028–2036.
- **Key constraints:** Limited allocated research hours meant prioritizing questions the internal dataset structurally cannot answer (mobile, free-to-play, current growth rates) over re-deriving patterns the dataset already shows directly. Relied on publicly available market-research summaries rather than full paid industry reports; no primary consumer surveys were conducted.

3. Research Approach

- **Types of questions asked:** (1) current global market size and platform revenue split, (2) which platform is growing fastest and why, (3) current genre and business-model revenue distribution, (4) regional market concentration, (5) publisher/competitive concentration and recent M&A activity.
- **How research effort was prioritized:** Research time was concentrated on signals the internal dataset cannot see at all — mobile and free-to-play revenue, and post-2016 platform trends — rather than re-confirming genre or publisher patterns already visible in the dataset. Cross-source triangulation was prioritized over depth on any single report, since multiple market-research firms publish conflicting market-size estimates.
- **Tools used within Amazon Quick Suite:** Quick Research for external market queries (market size, platform share, genre trends, competitive landscape); Quick Chat (Q) to query and cross-reference the internal dataset by genre, platform, and region; the Market Intelligence Agent to synthesize dataset findings and Quick Research outputs into the Market Analysis and this Brief.

4. Key Market Insights

Insight 1

Insight Summary: The internal historical dataset shows Action, Sports, and Shooter as the top genres by cumulative global sales, but this understates today's market because mobile and free-to-play titles — which the dataset does not track at all — now account for the majority of industry revenue.

Supporting Evidence or Signals: Internal dataset: Action, Sports, and Shooter rank as the top three genres by cumulative global sales across the ~1980–2016 window covered. External: mobile accounts for roughly 52% of the global games market (~\$107B of ~\$205B in 2026, Newzoo-based estimates), and free-to-play represents 61.5% of industry revenue (Straits Research, 2025) — both categories the internal dataset structurally excludes.

Why This Insight Matters: A genre or platform decision based on the internal dataset alone would be optimizing for less than half of today's actual market.

Confidence Assessment: Source quality: High (Newzoo is the games industry's standard market tracker). Consistency: High (multiple independent sources agree mobile share is roughly 50%+). Timeliness: Current (2026 data). Overall confidence level: High.

Insight 2

Insight Summary: PC, not console, is currently the fastest-growing platform — posting a record 12.0% revenue growth in 2025 versus console's much slower 2.8% — and Newzoo projects PC will overtake console in total revenue by 2028, a reversal the internal dataset's console-dominated historical record could not have anticipated.

Supporting Evidence or Signals: Internal dataset: console-generation platforms (PS2, Wii, DS, PS3, Xbox 360) dominate cumulative historical sales, with PC a minority share throughout the period covered (PC ranks 10th of all platforms). External: 2025 PC revenue reached \$43.6B on record 12.0% growth versus console's \$44.7B on just 2.8% growth; Newzoo projects PC's 6.6% forward CAGR will overtake console's 4.4% CAGR by 2028, driven by a broad slate of premium PC releases (Newzoo Global Games Market Report, retrieved via Quick Research, September 2026).

Why This Insight Matters: A platform-investment decision anchored to the historical dataset's console-heavy sales record would miss that PC has quietly become the more dynamically growing platform today — the opposite of what the internal data alone would suggest.

Confidence Assessment: Source quality: High (Newzoo is the games industry's standard market tracker, queried directly). Consistency: High (single authoritative source with transparent methodology; not yet cross-checked against a second independent source). Timeliness: Current (2025 data, retrieved September 2026). Overall confidence level: High.

Insight 3

Insight Summary: Japan shows a structurally different genre preference — a disproportionate skew toward Role-Playing titles — compared to the Action/Shooter/Sports skew seen in North America and Europe, a pattern that appears consistent with the continued commercial importance of Asia-based publishers today.

Supporting Evidence or Signals: Internal dataset: RPGs represent 27.3% of Japan's cumulative unit sales versus 7.5% (NA) and 7.7% (EU) — a ~3.6x overindex — while Shooter, the second-largest Western genre, is only 3.0% of Japan's sales. External (indirect corroboration): Asia-Pacific is the largest gaming region by revenue share (46–53% of global spend across sources), and two of the largest gaming companies globally, Tencent and NetEase, are China-based.

Why This Insight Matters: Supports a region-specific genre and localization strategy for market entry rather than a single global title design, if the pattern still holds.

Confidence Assessment: Source quality: Medium (the regional genre pattern is well-established and precisely quantified within the internal dataset, but the external corroboration is indirect — regional market size, not a direct current genre-preference study). Consistency: Medium (the two signals point the same direction but do not directly confirm each other). Timeliness: Internal signal is 10+ years old; external signal is current. Overall confidence level: Medium.

Insight 4

Insight Summary: Publisher market power was already concentrated in the internal historical data and has intensified further through recent acquisition activity, raising the competitive bar for a new or smaller entrant.

Supporting Evidence or Signals: Internal dataset: the top four publishers by cumulative sales (Nintendo, Electronic Arts, Activision, Sony) account for 47.4% of all-time unit sales, despite competing against 578 distinct publishers in the dataset. External: the top 10 publishers now capture roughly 60% of global industry revenue, and Microsoft's \$69 billion acquisition of Activision Blizzard (completed October 2023) is a concrete, recent example of accelerating consolidation, folding Call of Duty, World of Warcraft, and Candy Crush into Xbox Game Studios.

Why This Insight Matters: Informs whether to pursue an independent multi-platform release or a platform-exclusive partnership, and sets realistic expectations for the revenue share a new entrant can capture.

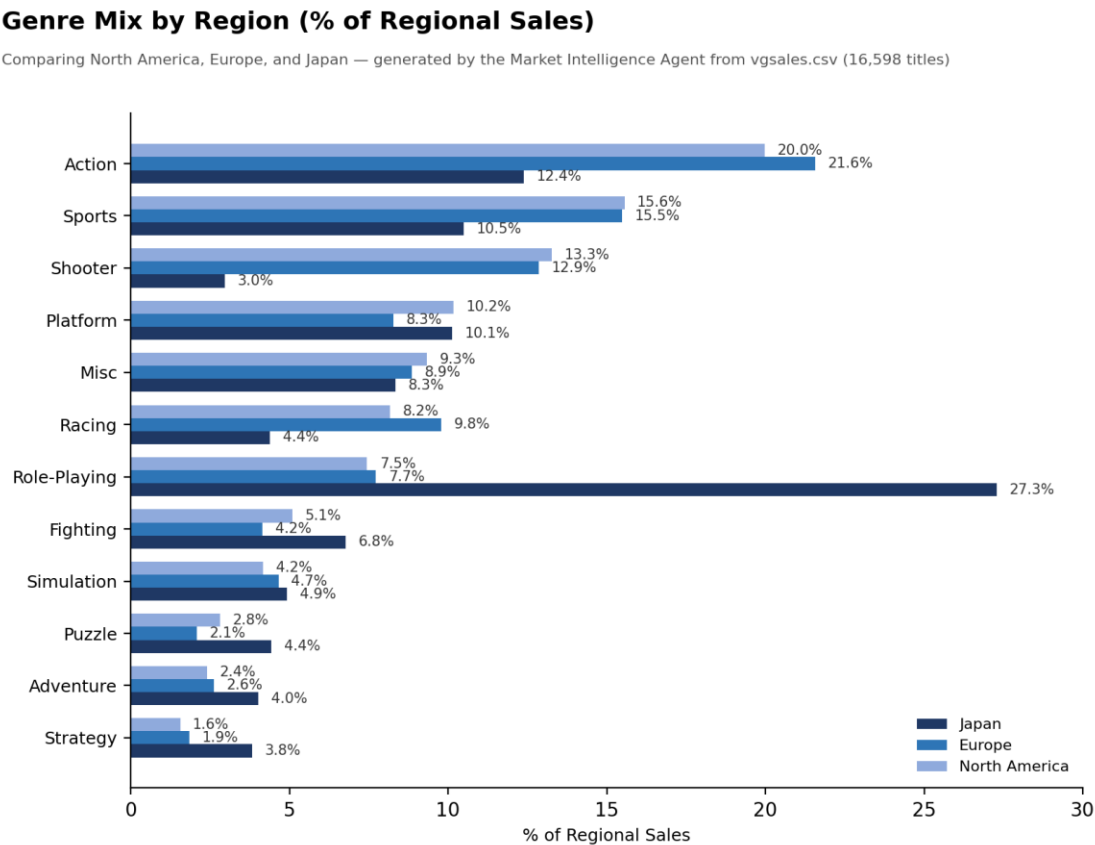
Confidence Assessment: Source quality: High (recognized market-research firm; the acquisition is public record). Consistency: High (internal and external signals point the same direction). Timeliness: Current. Overall confidence level: High.

5. Visual Evidence

Chart Type: Bar chart — “Genre Mix by Region (% of Regional Sales)”, generated directly from the internal vgsales.csv dataset by the Market Intelligence Agent.

What the visualization shows: The share of each region's total unit sales held by each of the 12 genres. Japan's Role-Playing share (27.3%) is roughly 3.6x North America's (7.5%) and Europe's (7.7%), while Japan's Shooter share (3.0%) is a fraction of NA's (13.3%) and Europe's (12.9%). Action and Sports lead in NA/EU but rank lower in Japan.

How it supports the insight: Makes Insight 3's regional divergence visible at a glance and backs it with a precise, agent-generated figure rather than a qualitative description.



Genre Mix by Region — generated live by the Market Intelligence Agent from vgsales.csv

6. Confidence Assessment (Overall)

Source quality: Mixed but generally strong — external findings draw primarily on Newzoo-based industry tracking (the games-industry standard) and named market-research firms (Mordor Intelligence, Straits Research), with one insight (Japan/RPG) resting on indirect corroboration rather than a direct current study.

Consistency across sources: High for platform, business-model, and publisher-concentration findings, where multiple independent sources converge; lower for the exact global market-size figure, where sources range from roughly \$189B to \$330B for 2026 depending on scope.

Timeliness of information: External research is current (2025–2026); the internal dataset is historical (through approximately 2016), which is treated as a limitation throughout rather than hidden.

Overall confidence level: High for Insights 1, 2, and 4; Medium for Insight 3.

7. Limitations and Risks

- **Missing data:** The internal dataset only captures retail/packaged unit sales through roughly 2016 and includes no mobile, free-to-play, subscription, or in-game/DLC revenue — meaning more than half of today's actual industry revenue is structurally invisible to it.
- **Conflicting signals:** External market-size estimates for 2026 range from approximately \$189 billion to \$330 billion depending on whether hardware, esports, and peripheral spending are included, so any single headline figure should be treated as directional rather than precise.
- **Potential bias or ambiguity:** The Japan/RPG regional finding (Insight 3) combines a decade-plus-old dataset pattern with an indirect modern signal rather than a direct current study, and should be validated with current regional data before being used to size a specific investment. Separately, exact figures in the internal dataset can vary slightly between different public copies of it, so figures should be confirmed against the specific file loaded into the agent.

8. Strategic Implications

What decisions could this inform?

- Whether to prioritize a premium console/PC title or a mobile free-to-play title for the next investment.
- Which region to treat as the primary launch market and how much to invest in region-specific genre choices or localization.
- Whether to pursue an independent multi-platform release or a platform-exclusive partnership, given publisher concentration.

What should not be concluded from this research?

- That console is now more strategically important than mobile overall — mobile revenue remains more than double console's; console is simply the faster-growing segment off a smaller base.
- A specific dollar revenue projection for a hypothetical new title — this analysis supports directional platform, genre, and regional prioritization, not a financial forecast.
- That the Japan/RPG regional preference is confirmed for 2026 — per the limitations above, this should be treated as a hypothesis worth validating, not an established current fact.

9. Summary for Leadership

This brief evaluates whether historical video game sales patterns still hold in today's market to inform where to prioritize our next title investment. The internal sales dataset and current external market research agree on two durable structural patterns: publisher revenue is heavily concentrated at the top, and regional genre preferences differ meaningfully, with Japan skewing toward RPGs relative to Western markets. However, the dataset substantially understates today's market because it predates mobile and free-to-play gaming, which together now make up more than half of the industry's roughly \$205 billion in 2026 revenue. Contrary to what the console-heavy historical dataset would suggest, PC is now the fastest-growing platform — a record 12.0% growth in 2025 versus console's 2.8% — and is projected to overtake console in total revenue by 2028. Overall confidence in the platform, business-model, and publisher-concentration findings is High; confidence in the regional genre finding is Medium, since it combines historical data with indirect current evidence rather than a direct current study. We recommend treating this analysis as a directional input for platform and regional prioritization alongside a fresh, mobile-inclusive market study, not as a standalone revenue forecast.